

Probationary Officers Recruitment Examination

Pre-Examination Training

Descriptive Paper (Communication Skills)

Set-4

- 1. Draft a formal email to be sent to high-net-worth individuals (HNIs) introducing the bank's new "Premium Savings Account" and its exclusive benefits.**
- 2. A customer is verbally abusing a junior cashier due to a disagreement over a check clearance. As the Branch Manager, analyze how to de-escalate the situation while maintaining staff morale.**
- 3. Based on a month-long feedback survey, write a report detailing the top three reasons for customer dissatisfaction at the "Help Desk" and provide recommendations.**
- 4. Write a suitable title and summarize the following passage in one-third of the total words.**

The banking sector has undergone a remarkable transformation with the rapid growth of digital technologies. Customers today expect faster, convenient, and personalised banking services available anytime and anywhere. This has led to the emergence of digital-only banking models, where services are provided entirely through online platforms. At the same time, many banks continue to adopt the phygital model, which combines physical branches with digital banking tools to provide a balanced customer experience.

Digital-only banking offers several advantages. It reduces operational costs by eliminating the need for extensive branch networks and enables customers to access services through mobile applications and internet platforms. Account opening, fund transfers, loan applications, and investment services can be completed quickly without visiting a branch. Digital-only banking also uses technologies such as Artificial

Intelligence, data analytics, and automation to provide personalised services and improve efficiency.

However, digital-only banking faces certain limitations. Not all customers possess adequate digital literacy or access to reliable internet services. Elderly citizens, rural populations, and customers requiring personalised guidance may find complete dependence on digital platforms challenging. Concerns regarding cybersecurity, data privacy, and online fraud also influence customer confidence in fully digital banking systems.

The phygital model addresses many of these limitations by combining the convenience of digital banking with the trust and support provided by physical branches. Customers can use mobile banking, ATMs, and online services for routine transactions while approaching branches for complex requirements such as financial advice, loan consultation, grievance resolution, and specialised services. This approach is particularly relevant in countries like India, where diverse customer segments have varying levels of digital adoption.

The future of banking is likely to be shaped by a hybrid approach rather than a complete shift towards either model. Digital tools will continue to improve efficiency, while physical branches will evolve into advisory and relationship management centres. Banks must focus on creating seamless integration between digital platforms and branch services.

In conclusion, digital-only banking represents innovation and efficiency, while the phygital model ensures inclusiveness and customer trust. The ideal banking system will be one that uses technology to enhance services without losing the human connection that remains essential in financial relationships.